```
echo "Enter a number: ";

$a = intval(fgets(STDIN));

if ($a < 0) {
    printf("%d is a negative number\n", $a);
} elseif ($a == 0) {
    printf("%d is a zero\n", $a);
} elseif ($a > 0) {
    printf("%d is a positive number\n", $a);
}

?>
```

We read a value from the user using the fgets() function. The value is tested if it is a negative number or positive or if it equals to zero.

```
$ php ifelsestm.php
Enter a number: 4
4 is a positive number
$ php ifelsestm.php
Enter a number: -3
-3 is a negative number
```

Sample output of the program.

2.3.2 PHP Switch Statement

The switch statement is a selection control flow statement. It allows the value of a variable or expression to control the flow of program execution via a multiway branch. It creates multiple branches in a simpler way than using the if, elseif statements. The switch statement works with two other keywords: case and break. The case keyword is used to test a label against a value from the round brackets. If the label equals to the value, the statement following the case is executed. The break keyword is used to jump out of the **switch statement**. There is an optional default statement. If none of the labels equals the value, the default statement is executed.